

# MP-GEN-001 General Prior Authorization Requirements

## 1 Purpose and scope

This policy sets the requirements that apply to every advanced imaging prior authorization request submitted to Meridian Health Plan, in addition to the procedure-specific policies. Meridian Health Plan is a fictional payer created for a portfolio project, and this document is not clinical guidance.

### 2.1 Member and provider information

Every request must include the member ID, the member's date of birth, the ordering provider's NPI and the name of the rendering facility.

### 2.2 Procedure and diagnosis codes

Every request must include the CPT code for the requested procedure and at least one ICD-10 diagnosis code that is supported by the clinical note.

### 2.3 Age of clinical notes

Clinical notes submitted with a request must be dated within 60 days before the date of the request. Older notes are not accepted as supporting documentation.

### 2.4 Laterality

Requests for imaging of an extremity or joint must state laterality (right or left). A request without laterality is pended for additional information.

## 3.1 Standard review

A decision on a complete request is made within 5 business days of receipt.

## 3.2 Expedited review

A request is reviewed as expedited when the ordering clinician certifies that waiting for a standard review could seriously jeopardize the member's life, health or ability to regain function. A decision on an expedited request is made within 72 hours.

## 3.3 Retrospective requests

Requests submitted after the service has already been performed are not accepted, except for emergency services. For an emergency service, the request must be submitted within 2 business days after the service.

## **4.1 Requests for additional information**

When a request lacks required information, Meridian pends the request and asks the provider to respond within 14 calendar days.

## **4.2 Administrative denial**

If the requested information is not received within 14 calendar days, the request is denied administratively. The provider may submit a new request at any time.

## **5.1 Denial notice**

A written denial notice states the specific policy criterion that was not met.

## **5.2 Peer-to-peer review**

The ordering clinician may request a peer-to-peer discussion with a Meridian medical director within 5 business days after a denial.

## **5.3 Appeals**

An appeal must be filed within 180 calendar days of the denial notice. Expedited appeals are decided within 72 hours.

## **6 Documenting conservative therapy**

To count toward a conservative therapy requirement, a treatment must be documented by a licensed clinician with the treatment type, start date, duration and the patient's response. Self-directed treatment that is reported only by the patient, such as over-the-counter medication with no clinician documentation of dose and duration, does not count on its own.